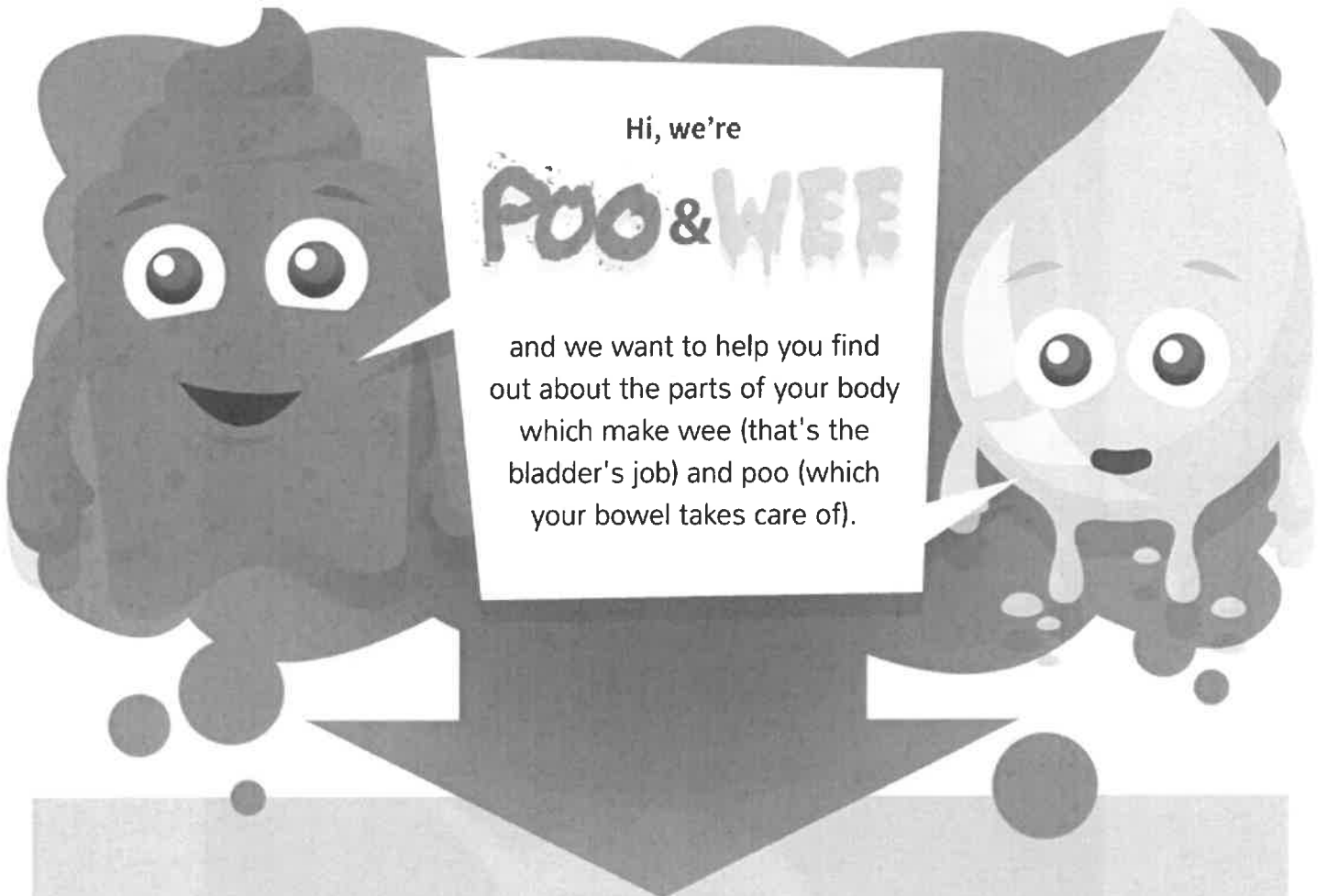


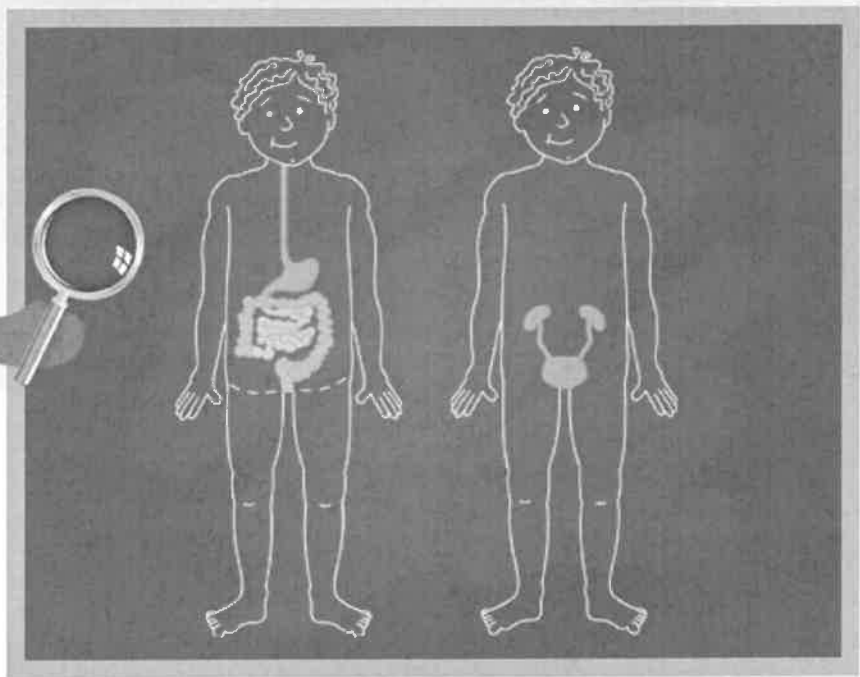
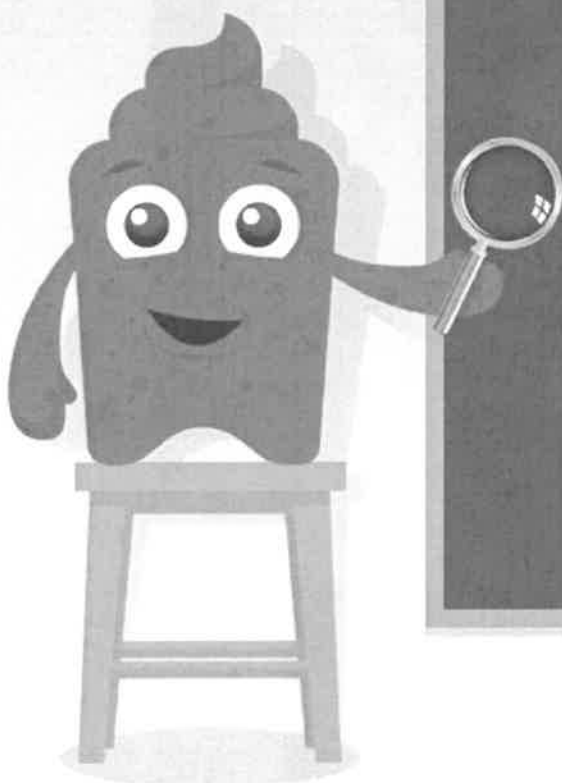
A large, stylized illustration at the top of the page features two cartoon characters. On the left is a dark, fluffy character representing 'poo' with large eyes and a smile. On the right is a light, teardrop-shaped character representing 'wee' with large eyes and a smile. Between them is a white rectangular box containing text. A large, dark, downward-pointing arrow is positioned below the text box, pointing towards the main body of text.

Hi, we're

POO & WEE

and we want to help you find out about the parts of your body which make wee (that's the bladder's job) and poo (which your bowel takes care of).

Most of the time your bladder and bowel get along fine, but for some kids they can get up to mischief and you end up having accidents in the day or during the night. There are lots of different ways that you can help us to get along and work nicely so you don't have to worry about having accidents anymore. But first of all, here's how wee and poo get made by your body...





HOW DOES OUR FOOD TURN INTO POO?

When you eat your food, it gets chewed into little pieces so it's easier to swallow. It then goes into your stomach where it gets mashed about even more and turned into a soupy mixture.

Next stop is your small bowel which is where all the nutrients (that's the good stuff) is taken out to be used by the rest of your body.

AMAZING FACT:

The small bowel can be up to 6 metres long and is a greyish purple colour.

The waste liquid (watery poo) then heads on down to the large bowel where there are strong muscles which squeeze the poo along. As it travels along, water is soaked up by your body and the poo soup is turned into a nice, smooth sausage shaped poo. Last stop for your poo is your bottom so you can pop it out into the toilet and flush it goodbye!

AMAZING FACT:

Lots of mammal babies actually eat their parents' poo! These include koalas, pandas, elephants, rats, mice and rhinos! It's because they need the right sort of bacteria in their stomachs to digest their food.

TUMMY TROUBLES!



Sometimes the sausage shaped poo hangs around in your bowel for a while and too much water is soaked up. This means it gets harder and more dried up, so it hurts when you try to push it out. Pooing 4 times or less a week and having painful, difficult to push out poos is called being constipated. Another constipation clue to look out for is runny poo or little pellets of poo in your pants. This is called soiling and happens when fresh poo leaks round the hard poo or lumpy bits break off and can appear in your pants without you knowing anything about it.

AMAZING FACT:

Some caterpillars fling their poo up to 3m to get rid of predators.

DID YOU KNOW?

Floating poos have an unusually high gas content!

Continued on next page...

How you can help keep poo on the move:

We don't always know why some kids get constipated, but there are lots of ways you can help your poo stop hanging around being a pain in the bum!

TOP 5 POO MOVING TIPS:

1. Sit on the toilet after every meal for at least 5 minutes to see if a poo is ready to be pushed out (about 20 minutes after eating breakfast is a really good time to lose that poo before going to school). **
2. Take your medicine if that's what the doctor says you need to keep your poo soft.
3. Help keep poo soft by drinking at least 6-8 glasses of water based fluid every day (squash or juice are also fine).
4. Run around a lot (exercise helps to keep poo moving).
5. Eat lots of different foods including fruit and vegetables (5 a day to help keep hard poo away).



**** Bonus Tip:** If you sometimes have pooing accidents at school, take a bag with a change of clothes, some spare pants and some wipes so you can clean yourself up. Ask mum or dad to look in the shops for some special kids pads which can help with this as well.



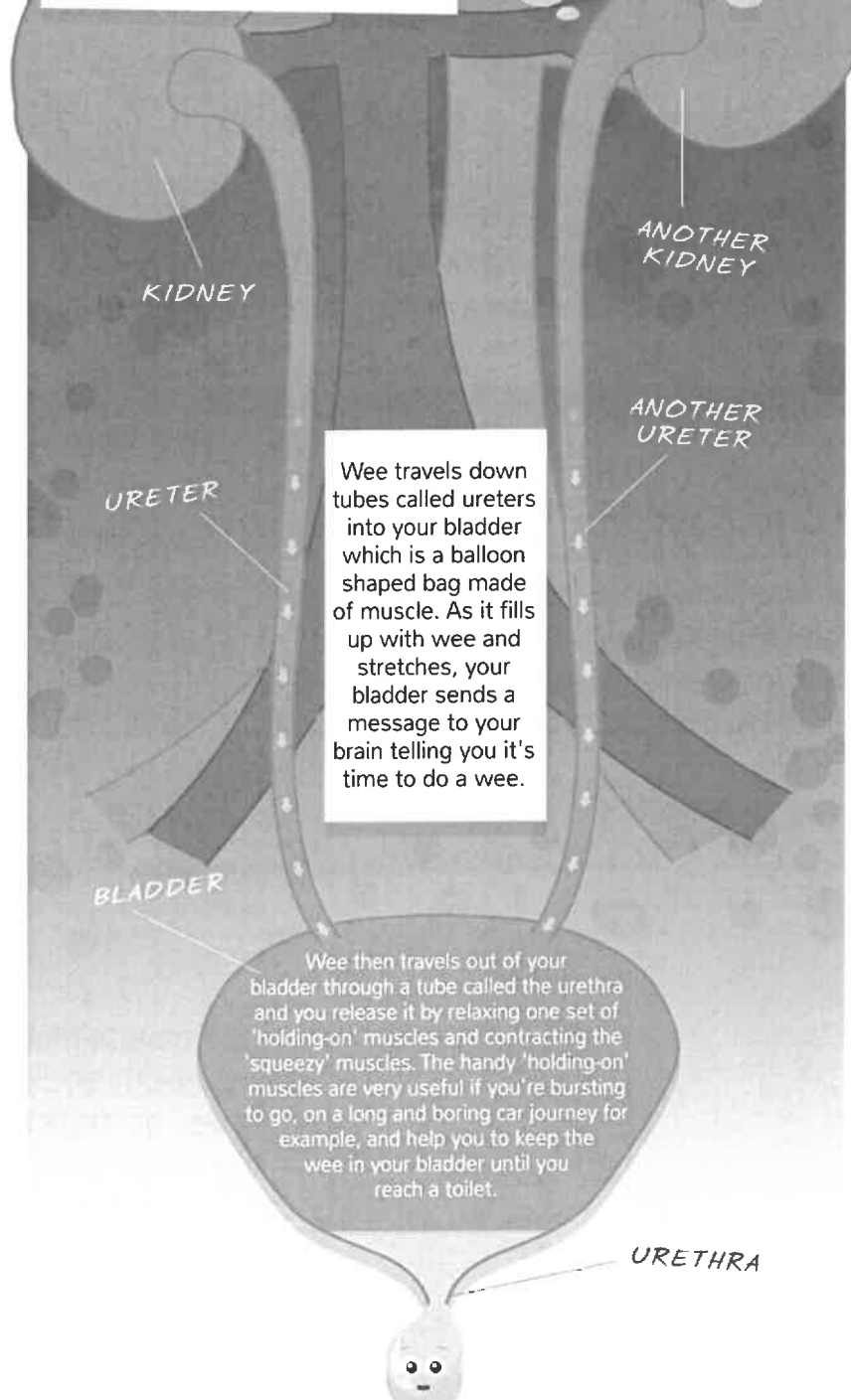
DID YOU KNOW?

We use the same muscles for blowing as we do for pooing so find a toy trumpet and toot whilst you poop!



HOW DOES MY BODY MAKE WEE?

Just like when you make 'Poo', after eating and drinking, your body soaks up all the fluid and this goes into your bloodstream. The blood is then pumped through your kidneys and they filter out the waste which is also known as urine or wee (your kidneys are like little wee factories).



Wee travels down tubes called ureters into your bladder which is a balloon shaped bag made of muscle. As it fills up with wee and stretches, your bladder sends a message to your brain telling you it's time to do a wee.

Wee then travels out of your bladder through a tube called the urethra and you release it by relaxing one set of 'holding-on' muscles and contracting the 'squeezey' muscles. The handy 'holding-on' muscles are very useful if you're bursting to go, on a long and boring car journey for example, and help you to keep the wee in your bladder until you reach a toilet.

AMAZING FACT:

An Egyptian Pharaoh used a woman's wee as eye wash to cure an eye infection and then thanked her by marrying her!

WEE WORRIES IN THE DAYTIME

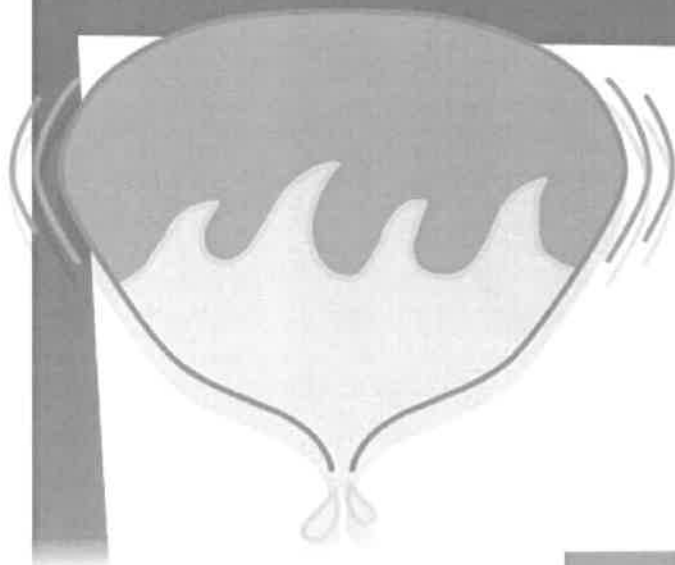
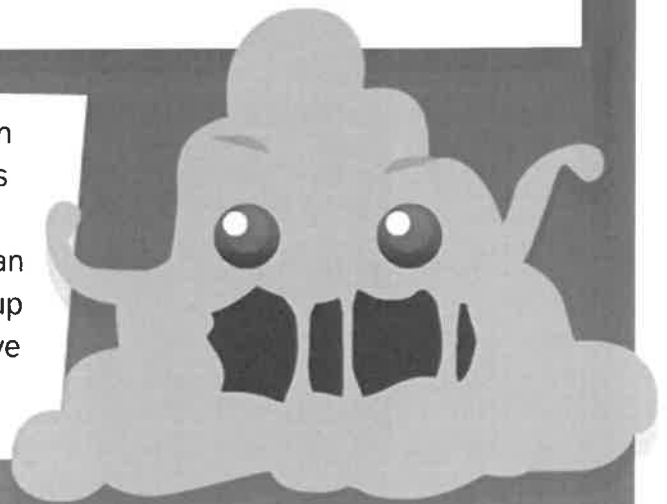
DID YOU KNOW?

The average person spends 3 years of their life on the toilet!



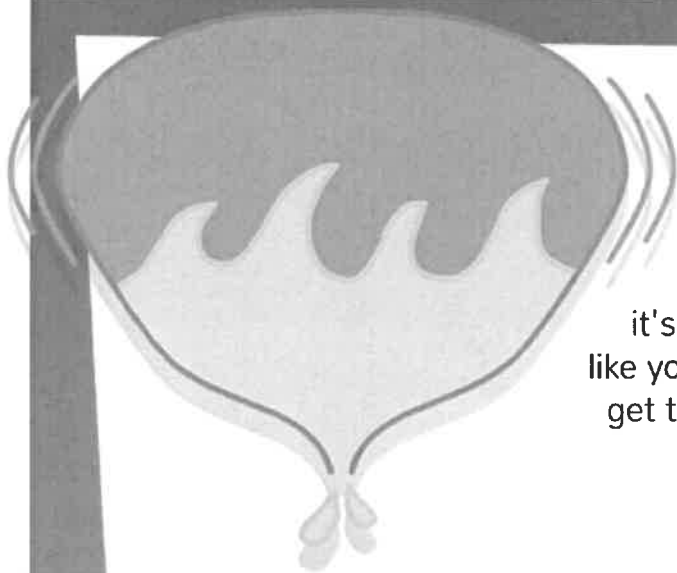
Some kids have wetting accidents which can either be a damp patch in your pants or a puddle on the floor. Here are some of the reasons why this might happen...

First up is a urinary tract infection (also known as an UTI) in the wee caused by bacteria. This can make you feel a bit poorly and you may need to go more often than usual. Your wee can also sting a bit and smell funny. Ask a grown up to take you to the doctor because they can give you medicine to make this better.



Or you could have a bladder which messes about and is called an 'overactive' or 'twitchy' bladder (a bit like when you're bored at school and start fidgeting).

Continued on next page...

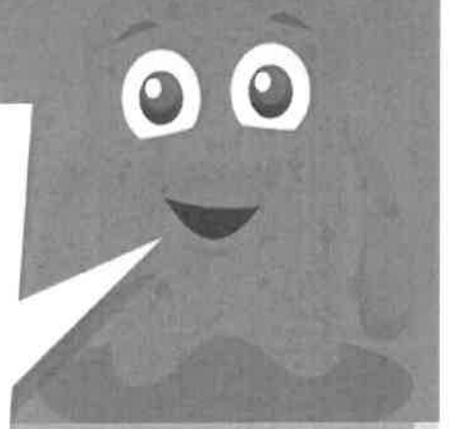


These bothersome bladders get a bit over excited and send a message to your brain to say you need to go before it's filled up properly. You may suddenly feel like you're bursting to do a wee but can't quite get to the toilet in time however fast you run.

DID YOU KNOW?

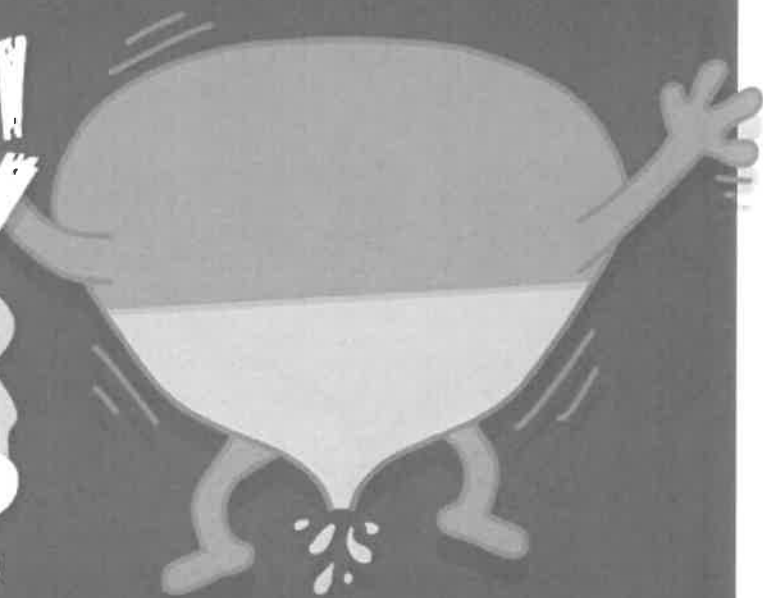
Kids need to do a wee between 4 and 7 times a day on average so if you're going more than this it could be because you've got a UTI or your bladder is overactive.

POO SAYS: Hey don't forget about me! If you've got a poo blockage in your bowel, it could be pressing against your bladder and making you feel like you need to do a wee. It could even stop your bladder from being able to hold as much wee as it should be able to. Check out the **top 5 poo moving tips** to fix that jam...



I can be a bit sneaky sometimes too! Have you ever been having so much fun, perhaps at playtime or you're in the middle of your favourite TV programme, and your bladder suddenly says it needs to empty me out? 'Wait a minute' you cry, 'I'm busy!'...and then oops, it's too late. I've made your pants wet and it's 1:0 to your bladder!

HOW CAN I MAKE MY BLADDER BEHAVE?



AMAZING FACT:

Wee was once used to make toothpaste because people believed it could make your teeth whiter!

HERE ARE THE TOP 6 RULES TO BECOME THE BOSS OF YOUR BLADDER:



Rule no 1: Drink at least 6 - 8 glasses of water based fluid throughout the day to help your bladder fill and stretch so it can hold more and stays healthy (don't forget drinking helps Poo to keep moving too!).

Rule no 2: Certain drinks can make an overactive bladder misbehave even more so you have even less time to dash to the loo. These include drinks with caffeine in them (so tea, coffee, cola and hot chocolate are a definite no-no).

Some kids also find that that blackcurrant/orange/fizzy drinks and ones with artificial colourings and flavourings can make your bladder worse. Try to work out if there are some drinks which make your bladder a bit grumpy and have a go at swapping it for something else.

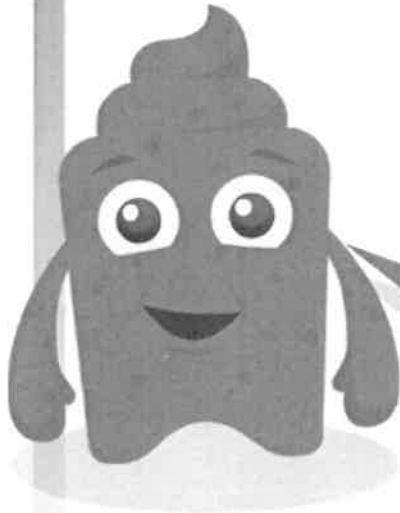


Continued on next page...



Rule no 3: Go to the toilet every 1.5 - 2 hours and even when you're busy doing something, try and listen to what your bladder is trying to tell you. A vibrating watch may help to remind you when you need to go.

Rule no 4: When you get to the toilet try and empty all the wee out of your bladder because leftover wee could give you an infection. When you get to the toilet, sit down, relax and take your time. Wee doesn't need to be pushed out like poo. If you're a boy who likes to wee standing up, trying aiming at a floating target or a ping pong ball.



POO SAYS: Boys - don't forget you need to sit down for some of your wees in case there's a poo who'd like to get out! Girls - when you've done a poo wipe from front to back so that the germs in your poo don't get near where your wee comes out.

Rule no 5: If you are having accidents, take a bag to school with you so you can change your pants and keep clean and dry. Staying in wet pants is no fun and this can also cause an infection. Ask your parents to let your teacher know you need to be allowed to go to the toilet whenever you need to and not just at break or lunch time. You could even think up a code word to use if you feel shy about asking.



Rule no 6: Any kids who are having wetting accidents should go and see their doctor or the school nurse who can help with the wetting accidents and make sure you haven't got an infection. There's also medicine you can take which helps to relax your bladder and stop it trying to empty whilst it's still filling up.

DID YOU KNOW? You can tell if you're drinking enough by the colour of your wee? Light yellow (almost like water) = full marks, dark yellow = try harder, drink more.

WEE WORRIES AT BEDTIME

Lots of kids (almost half a million in the UK) wet the bed when they're sleeping. You might feel sad about this and like you're the only one, but in a class of 30 children aged 7, two of them will be wet at night. It's really important to remember it's not your fault.



AMAZING FACT:

If you have one parent who wet the bed you have a 40% chance of doing the same and if you have two parents who were both wet it's a whopping 70%.

SO...

WHY DOES
BEDWETTING
HAPPEN?

Continued on next page...

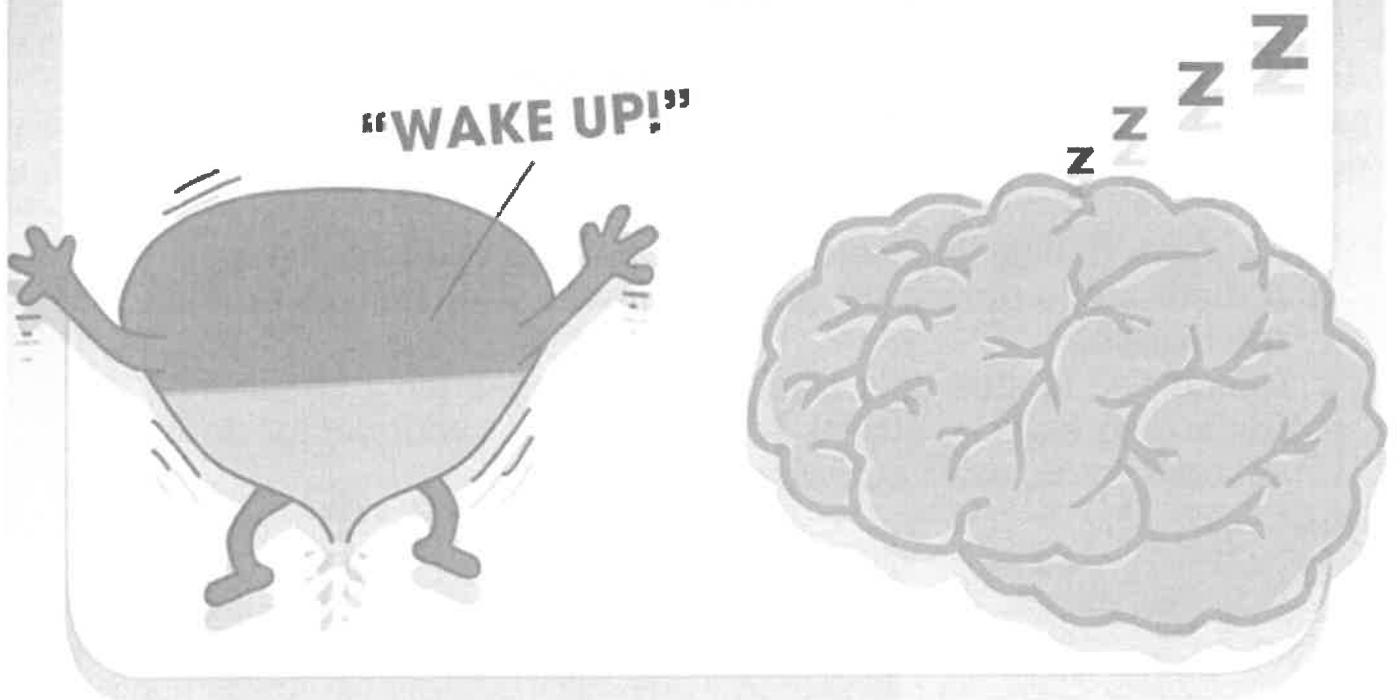
So, why does bedwetting happen? An overactive bladder which we talked about earlier can mess about at night just like it does in the daytime. It squeezes when it shouldn't whilst you're asleep and if you don't wake up you end up wetting the bed.

We also discovered that if you're constipated, the poo traffic jam in your bowel can stop your bladder holding as much as it should. So, when you go to sleep, your bladder can't fill up like it should and needs to empty more often.

Other kids haven't started to make enough of a hormone called vasopressin which your body needs to stop making so much wee at night.

The one thing that all kids who are wet at night have in common is that their bladder and brain don't communicate very well. As your bladder fills up it should send a message to your brain to wake you up, but your brain keeps snoozing and you wet the bed.

Most children grow out of wetting the bed, but there are things you can do to try and stop it happening.



TOP 5 WAYS TO BUST YOUR BEDWETTING



1. Try all the same drinking tricks that help an overactive bladder. So that's 6-8 cups a day of water based fluid. Watch out for things which can make bedwetting worse like anything with caffeine in it (tea, coffee, hot chocolate), fizzy drinks and blackcurrant squash. Don't forget drinking well also helps if you're constipated. Try clearing a poo traffic jam by following our poo moving tips and this should also help your bedwetting.

2. Do most of your drinking in the daytime and just have a small cup if you're thirsty an hour before bed. Try doing a wee as you're cleaning your teeth and then another one just before you tuck yourself in so your bladder has been fully emptied.

3. Ask a grown up to take you to see your doctor or school nurse. They can help you to find out why you're wet at night and help to find the right treatment for you. This might be:

- a. An alarm to help you learn to wake up when you need a wee
 - b. A medicine to reduce the amount of wee your kidneys produce in the night or
 - c. A medicine to stop your bladder squeezing when it shouldn't.
- Some children need alarms AND medicines - your doctor or nurse will help you to work out what you need.

Continued on next page...

4. Try to think about what may help you to get up and use the toilet in the night or if your alarm goes off. If you sleep in a bunk bed, make sure you get the bottom bunk, keep a torch near your bed and if you really don't fancy getting up in the night when it's cold and dark then ask a grown up if you can use a bucket!

5. Help whoever does the washing in your house to change the sheets if they are wet in the morning. Most importantly, think positive thoughts before you go to sleep each night "I can be dry, I will be dry!!".

"I CAN BE DRY, I WILL BE DRY!!"



For information and support on bedwetting, daytime wetting, constipation and soiling and potty training call

ERIC's Helpline on **0845 370 8008**
email: helpline@eric.org.uk
website: www.eric.org.uk

ERIC (The Children's Bowel & Bladder Charity) is a registered charity (charity number 1002424) and a company limited by guarantee (no. 2580579) registered in England and Wales. Registered office: 36 Old School House, Britannia Rd, Kingswood, Bristol BS15 8DB.

Facebook: **ERIC.UK1**, Twitter: **@ERIC_UK**, LinkedIn: **ERIC Training**

